INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / Nº 184 · HOT

Baseten

AI Infrastructure · Inference Platform · San Francisco (founded 2019) · Private ($13B; $1.5B Series F, Jun 2026)

Baseten, the inference platform behind Cursor, Abridge and Lovable, announced a $1.5B Series F on 22 June in two tranches at $13B and $11B, led by Altimeter, Conviction and Spark Capital. It is the fourth raise in 18 months for a company whose revenue grew 20x in a year.

76 OPPORTUNITY / 100	TIMING WINDOW	SERIES	RECOMMENDED TEAM	ACTION HORIZON
	HOT	**F1**	**TGR Haas F1 Team**	**6-10 WKS**

THE CASE

Baseten's own release of 22 June puts the numbers on record: $1.5B across two tranches at $13B and $11B, co-led by Sands Capital and Wellington, with Greylock, IVP, Battery and D.E. Shaw Ventures behind them; more than $2B raised in total. The price has moved from $2.15B in September 2025 to $5B in January to $13B now. The platform serves more than 1 billion inference calls a day across 87 clusters on 18 clouds, revenue grew 20x in a year, and headcount is to triple in 2026 as the company builds an enterprise sales motion.

That last point is the opening. A developer-led brand that must now sell to CIOs needs a stage its rivals already occupy: CoreWeave took Aston Martin Aramco's AI cloud seat in May 2025 and Core Scientific sits on Cadillac's car. Baseten is the inference layer that runs on those clouds, not one of them, and it has no seat.

WHY NOW

The Series F was announced on 22 June and brand budgets are set in the quarter after a raise. Austin in late October and Las Vegas in November are the US stages left in 2026, and teams close 2027 partner rosters in the fourth quarter.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

$1.5B
$1.5B Series F announced 22 Jun 2026 in two tranches at $13B and $11B valuations, led by Altimeter Capital,...

$300M
Altimeter, Conviction, Spark Capital (leads); Sands Capital, Wellington (co-leads); Battery Ventures, Black...

$2B
more than $2B raised in total.

$2.15B
The price has moved from $2.15B in September 2025 to $5B in January to $13B now.

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

TGR Haas F1 Team ◆ RECOMMENDED	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	TAKEN	Dell Technologies
Aston Martin Aramco F1 Team	TAKEN	NetApp
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A $1.5B raise at $13B, a fourth round in 18 months and a stated pivot to enterprise selling put Baseten at peak brand-investment authority. The AI lane at Haas is open, the workstream is real, and two US races remain inside the window.

FUNDING EVENT · CATEGORY PRECEDENT · CATEGORY WHITESPACE · DISCOVERY: SCAN

WHY TGR HAAS F1 TEAM

Haas is the American team with the leanest engineering operation on the grid, backed since 2026 by Toyota Gazoo Racing as title and technical partner. Its technology roster is Mphasis, CommScope, Ruckus and Infobip; there is no cloud, GPU or AI-inference partner, so the lane is clean. A team that buys engineering capacity rather than building it is the natural first customer for compute you do not own; Austin is its home race.

VALUE TO TGR HAAS F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. The models a team trains (strategy and tyre-degradation, computer vision on pit-lane and onboard video, telemetry anomaly detection) must be served at race weekends at low latency and at a cost a small team can carry. Baseten runs them from cloud regions near each circuit with autoscaling, so Haas gets an inference layer under Toyota's data without buying GPUs. In return: Official AI Inference Partner, livery, US-race hospitality.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official AI Inference Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, covering the enterprise build-out and a probable listing window. Estimated $3-5M a year, part-payable in platform credits. Scope: sidepod placement, naming of the team's model-serving environment, US-race hospitality, engineering content with the Toyota programme.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Tuhin Srivastava

CEO & CO-FOUNDER, BASETEN · **VERIFIED**

Srivastava co-founded Baseten in San Francisco in 2019 with Amir Haghighat (CTO), Philip Howes (Chief Scientist) and Pankaj Gupta, and fronts every raise; a first sports partnership is his call. Path: Matt Slagle, Chief Revenue Officer, who owns the enterprise motion. No CMO or CFO is listed.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the enterprise pivot.

> *“Tuhin, you have raised $1.5B to sell inference to enterprises, and CoreWeave already bought the Aston Martin seat to sell them compute. The American team has an open AI lane and its home race in October. 25 minutes before Austin to see how it prices?”*

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING	CAPACITY	BRAND FIT	URGENCY	OPS FIT
17 / 20	**17** / 20	**14** / 20	**13** / 20	**15** / 20
Round announced 22 Jun; Austin and Las Vegas in window.	$1.5B raise at $13B; more than $2B raised in total.	Developer brand turning enterprise; B2B infrastructure.	Enterprise push and hiring; no hard deadline beyond Q4.	MODE A: serving the team's models at race weekends.

RISKS & COUNTERS

NO REVENUE ON RECORD Baseten reports growth multiples, not revenue; Sacra's ~$600M annualised figure is an outside estimate. Counter: Anchor on the announced round and named customers; ask for the enterprise revenue mix on the first call.

CROWDED ARCHETYPE CoreWeave, Core Scientific, Oracle, Microsoft and Google Cloud all carry AI or cloud messaging; another infrastructure logo can read as a follower. Counter: Position inference, not compute, as the category, and Haas as the team whose engineering budget it changes most.

SOURCES — 14 OF 14 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://www.baseten.co/about-us/
- https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260622645563/en/Baseten-Raises-$1.5-Billion-to-Power-the-Next-Era-of-AI-Inference
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